

# Plant species guides

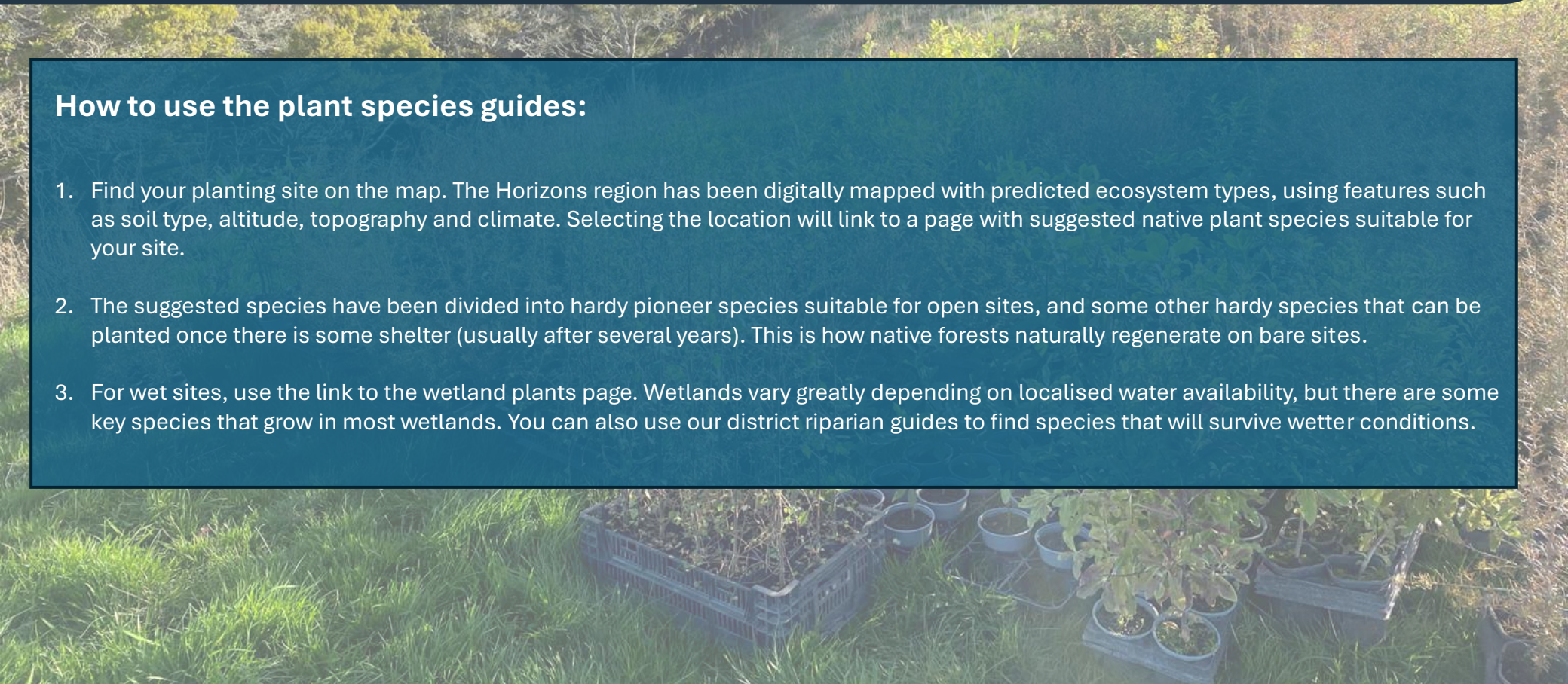
## Basics of planting:

1. Prepare your site well in advance.
2. Choose appropriate plants, using our plant species guides.
3. Order from nurseries ahead of time. Use nurseries that grow from local seed (ecosourcing).
4. Get your plants in the ground!
5. Maintain the site while the plants establish.

➤ Tips and links for further information on planting are on the following pages.

## How to use the plant species guides:

1. Find your planting site on the map. The Horizons region has been digitally mapped with predicted ecosystem types, using features such as soil type, altitude, topography and climate. Selecting the location will link to a page with suggested native plant species suitable for your site.
2. The suggested species have been divided into hardy pioneer species suitable for open sites, and some other hardy species that can be planted once there is some shelter (usually after several years). This is how native forests naturally regenerate on bare sites.
3. For wet sites, use the link to the wetland plants page. Wetlands vary greatly depending on localised water availability, but there are some key species that grow in most wetlands. You can also use our district riparian guides to find species that will survive wetter conditions.



# Tips for selecting plants

## Tips:

- The mapping has been done digitally at a broad scale and may not always incorporate local features, e.g. gullies or exposed slopes. Species in these guides have therefore been selected as a reliable starting point, rather than as hard and fast requirements.
- If you know there are existing plants at the site that don't seem to fit the suggested ecosystem type, listen to what nature is telling you! Look at the species guides for nearby ecosystem types and see if any seem to fit better. Species listed for each ecosystem are not comprehensive and there may be others also suitable for your site.
- Don't be tempted to plant less-hardy species too early. Many native species need shelter and cover to survive; frost, wind and drought can kill more vulnerable plants. Also, once your planting is big enough to provide a canopy, if there are nearby seed sources then natural regeneration can often do the work for you.
- There are a number of plants native to New Zealand, but not to the Horizons region. Planting species from other regions can lead to problems with these species becoming 'weedy' and outcompeting local species. Examples are karo and karaka, which are native to the north of the North Island. These species may still be suitable in amenity or cultural contexts, but shouldn't be planted in a mixed native planting in the Horizons region.
- Choose the exact plant species carefully. There are some common plants that have different varieties and cultivars available, some of which may be unsuitable for your site. Examples include kōwhai, mānatu (ribbonwood), harakeke (flax), tōtara, ti kōuka (cabbage tree) and houhere (lacebark). The pest plant Tasmanian ngaio is sometimes accidentally supplied by nurseries instead of the native ngaio. If you are unsure, check with your nursery or directly with Horizons.

# Useful links

- Extensive information on planting, from site preparation to best planting methods and long-term planning for the site. [Tāne's Tree Trust Documents](#) • [Establishing Native Forests](#)
- Plants suitable for riparian areas throughout the region: [All Publications - Horizons Regional Council](#) and search for 'riparian planting' to find the appropriate brochure for your district.

## Plant identification:

- If you know what it might be, search for pictures and a description: [Flora search results](#) • [New Zealand Plant Conservation Network](#)
  - If you're not sure what it could be, upload a picture to [A Community for Naturalists](#) • [iNaturalist](#) where others may help you identify it.
  - There are a number of apps (both paid and free) available for NZ plant species, e.g. Aotearoa Species Classifier, PlantNet, PlantSnap. Do be aware that these tools are not fool-proof (especially when using unclear pictures), so it is best to use them to provide suggestions for further verification.
  - Manaaki Whenua Landcare Research has ID keys for specialist identification of plant species: [Identification tools](#) » [Manaaki Whenua](#)
  - Weed identification and control information: [Weedbusters](#) • [Working together to protect Aotearoa New Zealand](#)
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- Farming with native biodiversity: [Resources - NZ Landcare Trust](#)
  - Links to further resources: [Get advice on planting trees | NZ Government](#)